Chapter 1
Child Groom

Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi was born on October 2, 1869, in Porbandar, India. Porbandar was a small state on the western coast of a very large country. Mohandas, called Mohan by his family, grew up with his mother, father, two half sisters from his father's previous marriages, oldest brother Laxmidas, sister Raliatbehn, and brother Karsandas. Mohan was the youngest. His father, Karamchand, was the *diwan* , or political leader, of Porbandar. The large family lived well, with servants, in a three-story house.

